

MVPFEASIBILITYREPORT · 2026

# Acumen.

Practise judgement before it counts.

Acumen helpsemergingbusinessleaderspracticerealistic decisions,  
understandtheirleadershiptendencies, andconnect  
withpeerswhosestrengthscomplementtheirown.

PRODUCT

Acumen  
Webappprototype

MODULE

MSIN0144  
GroupCoursework

GROUP47

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DATE

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## 01 · EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

### A feasible MVP for emerging leaders

Young people preparing for management roles are taught about leadership but rarely get to practise it. Case studies are abstract, internships are scarce, and traditional psychometrics are slow, expensive, and detached from the work itself. Acumen addresses this gap with short, scenario-driven simulations that surface how a user actually decides under pressure.

The beachhead is business students, young professionals, and aspiring founders; the premium later segment is next-generation (NextGen) successors in Asia-Pacific family businesses where leadership transitions carry significant economic stakes [3][1]. The MVP demonstrates a four-step loop — Simulate, Signal, Connect, Improve — across three live web scenarios. The model layers free premium individual access, university cohort pilots, and a premium NextGen pathway; an 18-responses survey and three interviews give directional evidence.

**Verdict.** Acumen is feasible as an early MVP — the simulation, feedback, and peer-discovery loop is demonstrated. Further user testing and scoring validation are needed before high-stakes use.

Optional questions addressed: first customers (\$2, \$7), market size (\$2), underlying technology (\$5).

# Why now, and who this is actually for

Three forces converge: a generation of young leaders who lack practical experience, a documented succession bottleneck in Asia-Pacific family businesses, and growing acceptance of simulation-based assessment in serious professional contexts.

## Who Acumen is built for

Acumen is built for anyone deciding earlier than expected — students running a society or capstone, early-career professionals promoted before training catches up, aspiring founders making a first hire. The common thread: they have read about leadership but not practised it, and the first poor call is paid in reputation. NextGen successors are the highest willingness-to-pay later segment, on top of a much larger pool with the same problem.

| SEGMENT                           | TRIGGER TO USE ACUMEN                                          | WHERE WE REACH THEM                                                    |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Business and engineering students | Recruiting, society leadership, capstone projects              | UCL, society partnerships, course tie-ins                              |
| Young professionals (0–4 years)   | First promotion, first hire, first cross-functional decision   | LinkedIn communities, employer learning & development programmes       |
| Aspiring founders                 | Pre-incorporation, first co-founder hire, first investor pitch | Accelerators, founder communities, university entrepreneurship offices |
| NextGen successors (later)        | Joining family business, governance training                   | Family-office networks, regional advisors                              |

## The "leadership-readiness" gap

Business education is rich in frameworks but poor in practice; internships compress months into weeks of memos, and graduate schemes defer decision authority to year two or three. Serious games increasingly assess soft skills [14], and McKinsey's Game-Based Innovation Lab shows simulation-based assessment now sits inside serious professional contexts [4].

## Why an Asia-Pacific focus

The premium segment is concentrated in Asia-Pacific, where family businesses dominate and a generational handover is underway. Between 2023 and 2030, Asia-Pacific families are expected to transfer roughly USD 5.8 trillion to the next generation [3]; PwC finds 43% of Indonesian NextGen citing senior resistance to handover [1], and Sukamdan notes Indonesian family companies contribute over 80% of GDP [7]. The anchor matters not because heirs will fund development, but because it gives Acumen a defensible reason to exist beyond a generic edtech pitch.

| Market sizing (top-down, 2024 figures) |                                                                  |        |                                                    |
|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|----------------------------------------------------|
| LAYER                                  | DEFINITION                                                       | SIZE   | SOURCE / ASSUMPTION                                |
| TAM                                    | Global early-career professionals + business/management students | ~50 m+ | UNESCO tertiary enrolments; OECD 0–5 yr graduates. |
| SAM                                    | UK business/management students + APAC NextGen pool              | ~250 k | HESA 2023/24 (~220 k); PwC NextGen cohort [2].     |
| SOM (Y1)                               | UCL beachhead via society + course tie-ins                       | ~5,000 | ~200 paid users at £9 plus 6 cohort licences.      |
| ACUMEN · FEASIBILITY REPORT            |                                                                  |        |                                                    |

## What Acumen is

Acumen helps emerging business leaders practise realistic decisions, understand their leadership tendencies, and connect with peers whose strengths complement their own.

The product is on a repeatable loop. Each session begins with a realistic scenario under time and information constraints, then converts the user's choices into a research-informed leadership signal. The signal is developmental, not diagnostic — it points toward what to practise next and toward peers whose strengths complement their own.

The framing draws on established theory: upper-echelons[10], Vroom-Yetton[11], Hersey-Blanchard[12], and Rest[13] — informing how decisions, participation, readiness, and ethical prompts are structured.



FIG. 1 Acumen introduces a simple promise: practise business judgement before it counts.

## The product loop

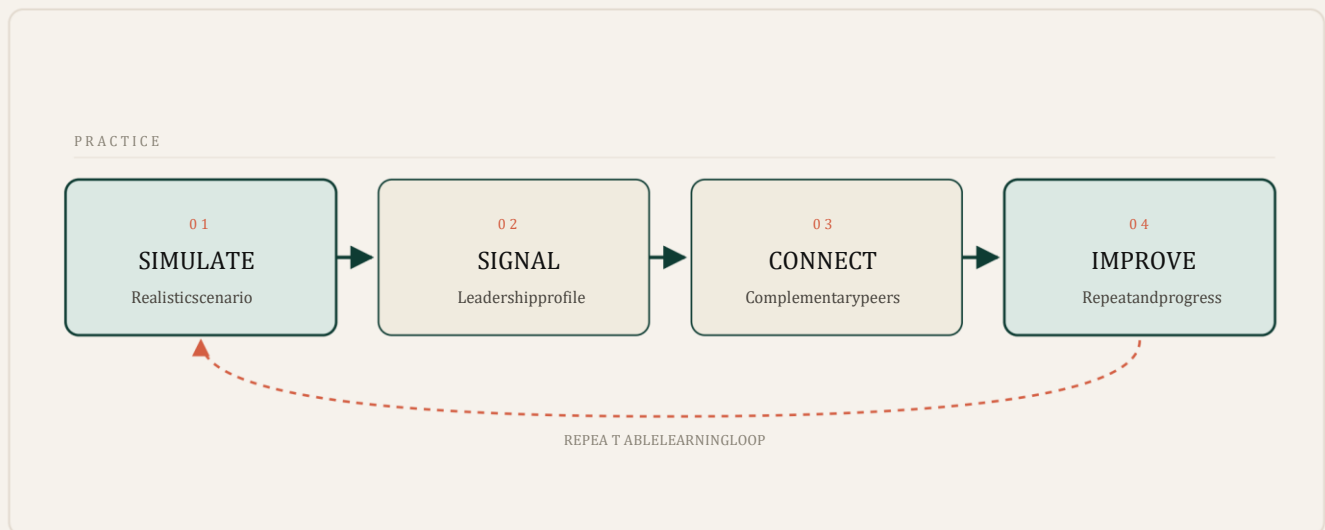


FIG. 2 Acumen turns business learning into a repeatable loop: users practise realistic decisions, receive feedback, connect with useful peers, and return to improve.

## How a user actually uses Acumen

The walkthrough shows Acumen's score loop: a user enters via a simple value proposition, completes a simulation, receives a leadership signal, and is guided toward complementary peers.

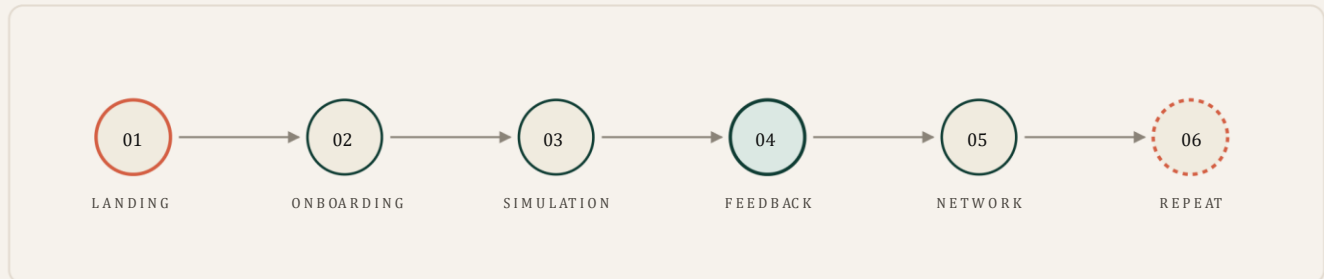


FIG. 3 Typical Acumen use case, shown as a sequence rather than a screen collage.

### Step 1 · Onboarding

A first-time user lands on a single-promise home screen and is taken into a short onboarding flow. Acumen asks what the user wants to develop: decision-making under pressure, ethical judgement, conflict navigation, or strategic communication. These selections shape the order in which scenarios appear and the framing of feedback.

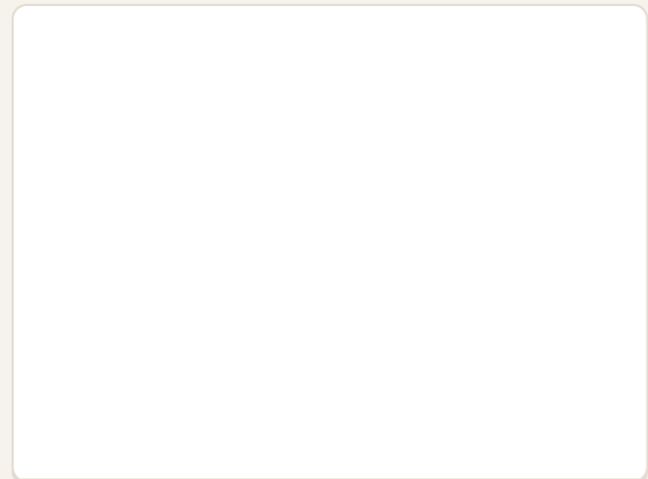


FIG. 4 Onboarding frames the experience around goals and skill development.

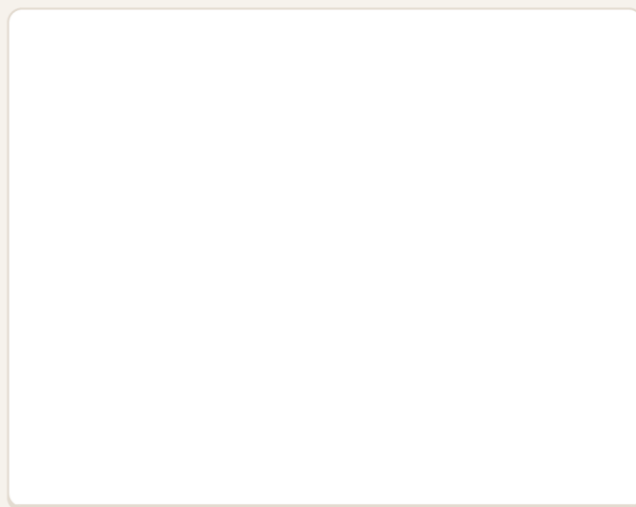


FIG. 5 The simulation places users in realistic trade-off decisions.

### Step 2 · The Succession Crisis

The user enters The Succession Crisis, a scenario in which a family-controlled mid-cap business must decide how to handle a contested leadership handover. The user faces sequenced decisions involving a politically connected board member, a capable but unfamiliar external candidate, and a long-serving family executive. Each decision is timed and information is deliberately incomplete, mirroring real management contexts. The scenario draws on succession themes documented in the PwC Indonesia work [1] and the literature on the weight of political and family ties in the region [9].

## From decision to signal to network

### Step 3 · A research-informed signal

Once the simulation closes, Acumen converts decision patterns into a developmental profile across five dimensions: strategic judgement, ethical reasoning, stakeholder management, decisiveness, and adaptability. The profile is presented as developmental feedback rather than a high-stakes score. Imbellus and McKinsey piloted and calibrated simulation-based assessment with McKinsey candidates from 2017 [5][8]; Acumen does not claim equivalent validation at MVP stage.

FIG. 6 Feedback converts choices into a research-informed leadership signal.

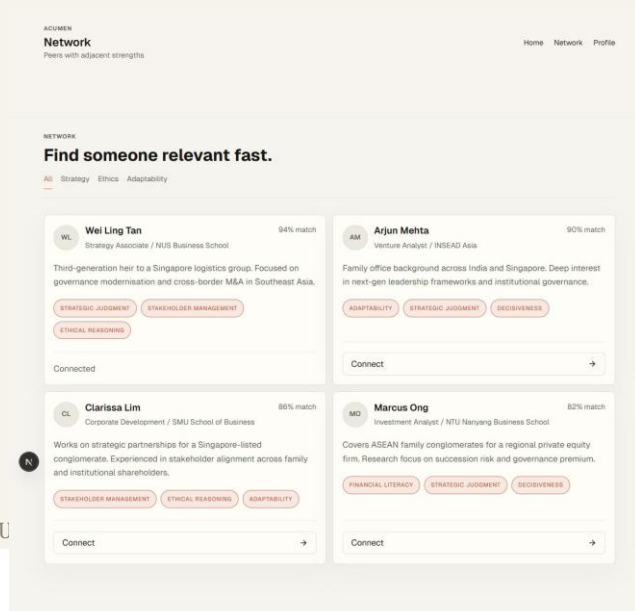
### Step 4 · Peer matching as social learning

The signal then suggests peers with complementary strengths — the same simulated experience produces a common vocabulary for collaboration. MVP matching uses profile-vector similarity over decision tendencies; deeper logic, CV parsing, and a global map view are a roadmap.

### Step 5 · Repeat and track

Repetition turns the loop into learning. The profile view records how a user's signal shifts over time. The Fading Division and The Authority Bypass broaden practice beyond succession. The MVP demonstrates the core simulation-feedback-peer loop; CV parsing, maps, recruitertools, and certificates are a roadmap, not MVP.

FIG. 7 Peer matching turns individual feedback into social learning.



# What actually has to work

The interface is simple; the components behind it are not. Three carry most of the product risk — simulation engine, scoring system, peer matching layer. Everything else is conventional web engineering.

## The three components that matter

| SIMULATION ENGINE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | SCORING SYSTEM                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | PEER MATCHING                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| As small state machine with four phases (deciding, ethical, twist, complete) drives user through scenario rounds, stakeholder document review, ethical prompts, and decision selection. Scenarios are stored as typed data, no hard coded UI, so new ones can be added without rewriting the engine. | Every choice is tagged behind the scenes. Those tags roll up into five scores describing how the user tends to decide: strategic judgement, ethical reasoning, stakeholder management, decisiveness, and adaptability. Each is anchored in established theory (Upper Echelons, Rest, Vroom-Yetton, Hersey-Blanchard, OODA). Validation against expert ratings is on the roadmap. | Matching surfaces peers with complementary rather than identical profile vectors. At MVP scale it runs against a seeded set of demo profiles; real matching becomes testable at roughly fifty active users. |

## Stack and architecture

| LAYER         | CHOICE                                                                         | WHY                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Framework     | Next.js with React and TypeScript                                              | Routing across distinct app views (landing, onboarding, simulation, feedback, profile, network); types make the data model self-documenting. |
| Styling       | Tailwind CSS; shared visual system in <code>globals.css</code>                 | Editorial palette stays consistent across pages without a heavy design system.                                                               |
| Interaction   | Lucide React icons; Framer Motion for transitions                              | Animation is restrained; transitions punctuate the loop rather than decorate it.                                                             |
| State         | Global React context provider; persisted to local storage with hydration check | The demo journey survives page refreshes; protected pages do not redirect before saved state has loaded.                                     |
| Scenario data | Strongly-typed TypeScript data files                                           | New scenarios are added as data, not code. The Succession Crisis, The Authority Bypass, and The Fading Division already use this pattern.    |
| Auth and data | Email login; anonymised profile vector only                                    | Reduces compliance surface and dishonesty with users about what is collected.                                                                |

## From decision to signal

### How a decision becomes a signal

The simulation reads a scenario from typed data and presents the user with rounds containing situations, options, and stakeholder documents. The state machine moves the user through deciding, optional ethical prompts, a final twist, then completion. On completion, the array of chosen options is passed to the scoring function, which maps each decision to its hidden tags across the five dimensions, applies bias detection, and produces an overall score plus a Vroom-Yetton style classification. The user is redirected to feedback, where the profile is rendered as plain-language summaries with dimension bars. The same profile vector then drives the network view, where peers are surfaced by complementarity rather than similarity.

### Honest limitations and IP

Acumen is a research-informed prototype, not a validated assessment platform. Scoring is framework-based but not externally validated against real-world outcomes; matching uses demo data; CV parsing, global maps, recruiter tools, and certificates are out of scope at MVP.

What is hard to clone is not the code base but the three things that compound: the scenario library (typed data with expert review per release), the calibrated feedback rubric (anchored in upper-echelons, Vroom-Yetton, Hersey-Blanchard, and Rest; expert-rater calibration is R5), and cohort-pilot network density (matching quality grows with usage, so a late entrant cannot match day one). All sit with the founding team; trade-mark filing is budgeted in Year-1 legal costs.



## A staged path to market

Acumen's business model is built around staged market entry, not a single target customer. The Business Model Canvas describes the broad beachhead; the Value Proposition Canvas focuses on the premium later segment. The relationship between them is sequential, not contradictory.

### Beachhead via the BMC

At MVP stage Acumen pursues business students, young professionals, and aspiring founders. They are reachable through universities and societies. Acquisition cost is low, willingness to test is high, and feedback loops are fast. Revenue in this layer is freemium, with paid scenario packs and saved progress.

### Premium via the VPC

The Value Proposition Canvas focuses on NextGen successors in Asia-Pacific family businesses. Their pains are structural: senior resistance to handover and the absence of a safe space to practise difficult decisions [1]. Revenue here comes from institutional pilots, but only after the loop is proven on the broader beachhead.

### Revenue streams

Acumen runs three streams: freemium individual converting to a paid scenario pack (live), institutional cohort licences for universities and societies (in outreach), and a premium NextGen programme (roadmap).

| STREAM                           | PRICE POINT                    | YEAR-1 TARGET<br>VOLUME | YEAR-1 REVENUE (ILLUSTRATIVE) |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Individual scenario pack         | £9 one-off                     | 1,200 unlocks           | £10,800                       |
| University cohort licence        | £1,500 per society<br>/ cohort | 6 institutions          | £9,000                        |
| NextGen pilot programme          | £8,000 per cohort              | 1 paid pilot            | £8,000                        |
| Total Year-1 revenue<br>(target) |                                |                         | £27,800                       |

Conservative target: ~1,200 scenario-pack unlocks at £9, six cohort licences, and one NextGen pilot. The SOM (\$2) leaves an order-of-magnitude headroom before saturating the beachhead.

### Cost structure

The cost base is light at MVP stage. Dominant lines are scenario authoring, serverless hosting, and a small UCL-focused marketing budget. Found time is shadow-priced for transparency but not drawn.

| LINE                                 | YEAR-1<br>ESTIMATE | NOTES                                                              |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scenario authoring and expert review | £6,000             | ~20 scenarios at MVP cost; expert review on contributor agreement. |
| Hosting and infrastructure           | £1,200             | Serverless backend; costs scale with usage.                        |
| Marketing and acquisition            | £3,500             | UCL society events, targeted LinkedIn, content.                    |
| Tooling, design, legal               | £2,300             | Trade-mark filing, design tooling, contractor support.             |
| Total Year-1 cost                    | £13,000            | Found time is shadow-priced, not drawn.                            |

## First-year cash flow and roadmap

### Monthly and cumulative cash flow

The chart below traces a conservative Year-1 trajectory under the volume targets above. The model assumes individual scenario revenue ramps from month three (after the first cohort pilot drives word-of-mouth), the university cohort licences land in months four, six, eight, ten, and eleven, and the single NextGen pilot closes in month nine. Costs are spread roughly evenly across the year. Net monthly cash flow turns positive in month four; cumulative cash flow ends Year 1 at approximately £14,800.

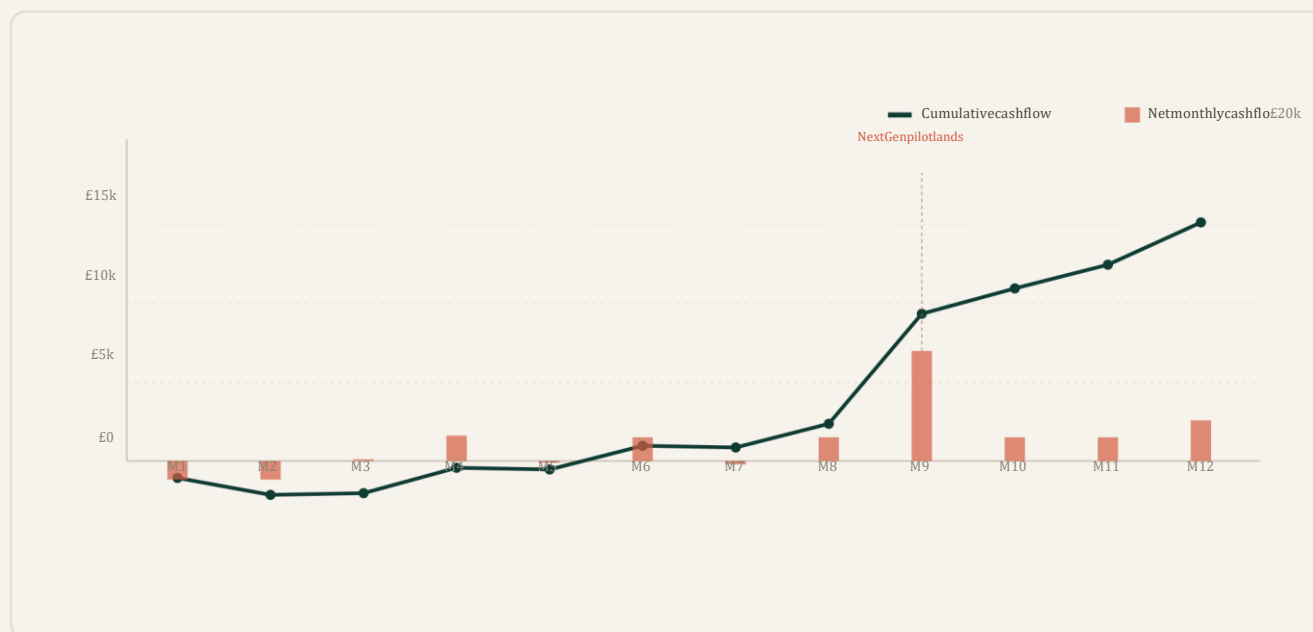


FIG. 8 Year-1 cash flow projection. Conservative ramp; founder timeshadow-priced. Cumulative cash flow ends Year 1 at approximately £14,800.

### Now / Next / Later

#### NOW · MVP

- Threelivewebscenarios
- Research-informed
- feedbackprofile
- Peerdiscoveyviaprofile
- similarity
- Freemiumpluspaid
- scenariopack

#### NEXT · 6–12 MONTHS

- iOSandAndroidbuildfor publiclaunch
- Additionalscenariosacross functions
- UCLandsocietycohort
- pilots
- Firstpayinginstitutional
- licence

#### LATER · 12–24 MONTHS

- Institutionalpilotsatscale
- Verifiedcompletion
- certificates
- NextGensuccession
- pathway
- B2Badvisoryorre recruiter
- tools

Out of scope at MVP: CV parsing, global map matching, paid certificates, recruiter dashboards, and fully validated scoring on the roadmap rather than in the current product.

## What users have told us so far

Three exploratory interviews and a short student survey were used to test early assumptions about the problem and the proposed solution. Sample sizes are small, so findings are directional rather than conclusive. They are most useful for surfacing hypotheses to test in the next cohort, not for projecting market behaviour at scale.

### How we ran it

Three in-depth, semi-structured 20–25 minute interviews — a final-year UCL student, a nearly-career professional in a first management role, and a pre-incorporation founder — followed a three-part guide: pain points, concept reaction after prototype walkthrough, and willingness to pay (full guide in Appendix B). A parallel five-question survey through UCL student networks returned 18 responses (12 students, 4 early-career, 2 founders) — directional, not representative.

#### Survey snapshot, n = 18

|                                                                                                  |         |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Few chances to practise judgement                                                                | 15 / 18 |
| Want feedback on how I decide                                                                    | 13 / 18 |
| Networking events feel transactional                                                             | 11 / 18 |
| Would try a 15-minute simulation                                                                 | 12 / 18 |
| Would pay for advanced scenarios                                                                 | 5 / 18  |
| Respondents agree or strongly agree on a 5-point scale. Small sample; treat as directional only. |         |

#### Voices from interviews

"The hardest part is not knowing if a decision was actually a good one. You make the call, things happen, and you never really get told why it worked or did not."

INTERVIEWEEA · FINAL-YEAR STUDENT

"LinkedIn is fine for the photo of you at a conference. It is not where you find the person you would actually phone before a hard meeting. I would pay if a tool genuinely got me better at deciding under pressure, and met me two or three people through it I wanted to know."

INTERVIEWEEB · EARLY-CAREER PROFESSIONAL

"I am not sure why I need to practise leadership when I am trying to start my own business but I will not be employing anyone any time soon, there are more important skills to be working on."

INTERVIEWEEC · ASPIRING FOUNDER, PRE-INCORPORATION

FIG. 9 Problem-statement agreement, n = 18.

## Reaction to the prototype

Each interviewee was walked through the Acumen prototype after the pain-point discussion. The 12 survey respondents who indicated openness answered the same closing prompts in free text. Three signals to surface: intention to use, perceived value, and the dissenting view.

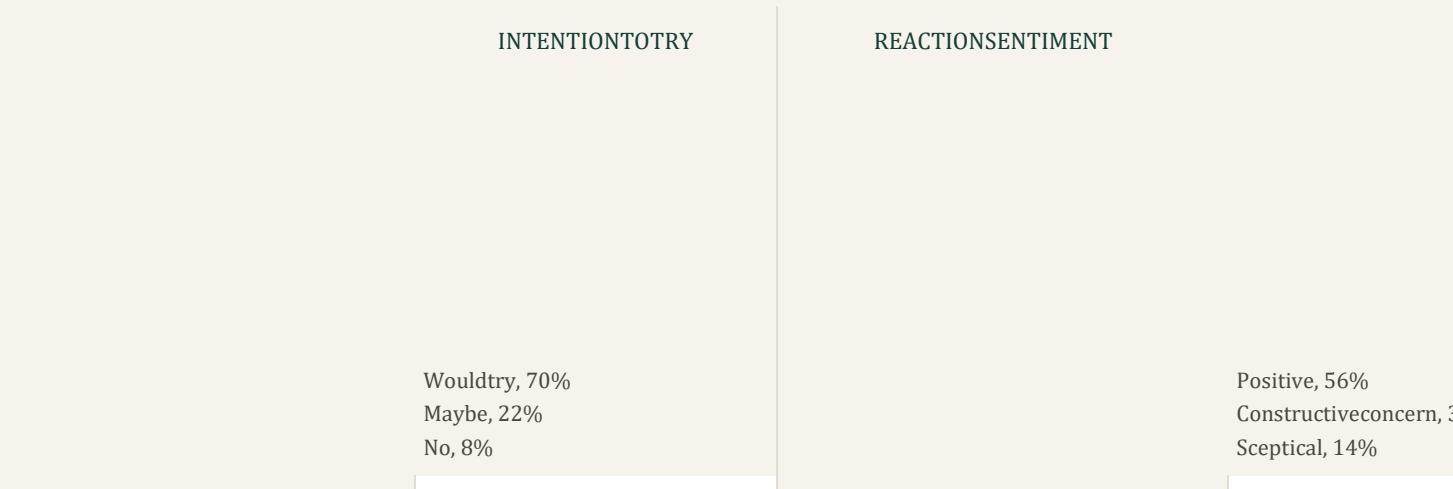


FIG. 10 Three pie charts of post-prototype reaction across survey free-text (n = 18) and interviews (n = 3), coded by the team



FIG. 11 Feature mentions in concept-reaction free text, n = 12.

## What we heard, and what changed

### Patterns across the three interviews

With only three conversations, we report what was said rather than how many agreed. The matrix below records, per interviewee, whether each topic was raised unprompted, raised after prompting, or not raised — a record, not a quantitative finding.

| TOPIC                                          | A · STUDENT    | B · PRO        | C · FOUNDER    |
|------------------------------------------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
| Wanted feedback on past decisions              | ● Unprompted   | ● After prompt | ○ Not raised   |
| LinkedIn-style networks felt shallow           | ● Unprompted   | ● Unprompted   | ● After prompt |
| Preferred interactive over course-style        | ● Unprompted   | ● Unprompted   | ● Unprompted   |
| Would prefer to use on mobile                  | ● Unprompted   | ● Unprompted   | ● Unprompted   |
| Concerned about thin user base at launch       | ○ Not raised   | ● Unprompted   | ● After prompt |
| Sceptical of "scoring" framing                 | ● After prompt | ● Unprompted   | ● After prompt |
| Sceptical of leadership practice as a priority | ○ Not raised   | ○ Not raised   | ● Unprompted   |
| Would pay for skill, not certificates          | ● After prompt | ● Unprompted   | ● After prompt |

● Raised without prompting ● Raised after prompt ○ Not raised in this interview

### What changed because of the interviews

Four product decisions followed: the leadership signal was reframed as developmental, not diagnostic; peer matching moved earlier in the journey; the mobile build was promoted from "later" to "launch" (all three interviewees preferred phone use); copy and onboarding were rewritten to be honest about scope.

### The cold-start concern

Interviewee B raised the sharpest concern: "the matching only works if there are actually people in there worth meeting." Response: a cohort-pilot model — closed UCL society pilots so everyone starts on the same day, guaranteeing a meaningful network at first contact.

### What still needs testing

Three open questions inform R1, R2, R6: whether users return, whether the signal is understood without a facilitator, and whether a society signs up a paying pilot. Next validation: a 40-user UCL cohort with telemetry on completion, return, and peer-messenger rates.

# SWOT and competitive structure

Two short analyses: SWOT for internal position, Porter for external market structure.

## SWOT

### STRENGTHS

- Clear simulation-based MVP
- Strong link to leadership readiness research
- Broad student beachhead with premium NextGen pathway
- Differentiated blend of decision practice and networking

### WEAKNESSES

- Scoring is research-informed, not validated
- Peer matching is still demo data
- Some roadmap features are not implemented
- Needs more user testing before stronger claims

### OPPORTUNITIES

- Universities and societies can provide early cohorts
- APAC family-business succession is a high-value later market
- Simulations can become more culturally specific over time
- Peer network can create retention if enough users join

### THREATS

- Generic AI coaching tools may look like substitutes
- McKinsey, LinkedIn, Coursera, or assessment firms could move into simulations
- Weak validation could damage credibility
- Users may see feedback as generic if not explained well

## What the SWOT actually tells us

Strengths cluster around clarity and design — the loop is easy to explain, research grounding is verifiable, and the practice + network proposition is differentiated. Weaknesses cluster around proof: the feedback model is research-informed but not calibrated, matching uses demo data. Opportunities are addressable short-term via cohort pilots; threats are competitive, sharpening the case for validation over feature breadth. Closing the evidence gap matters more than building anything new.

## Porter's Five Forces

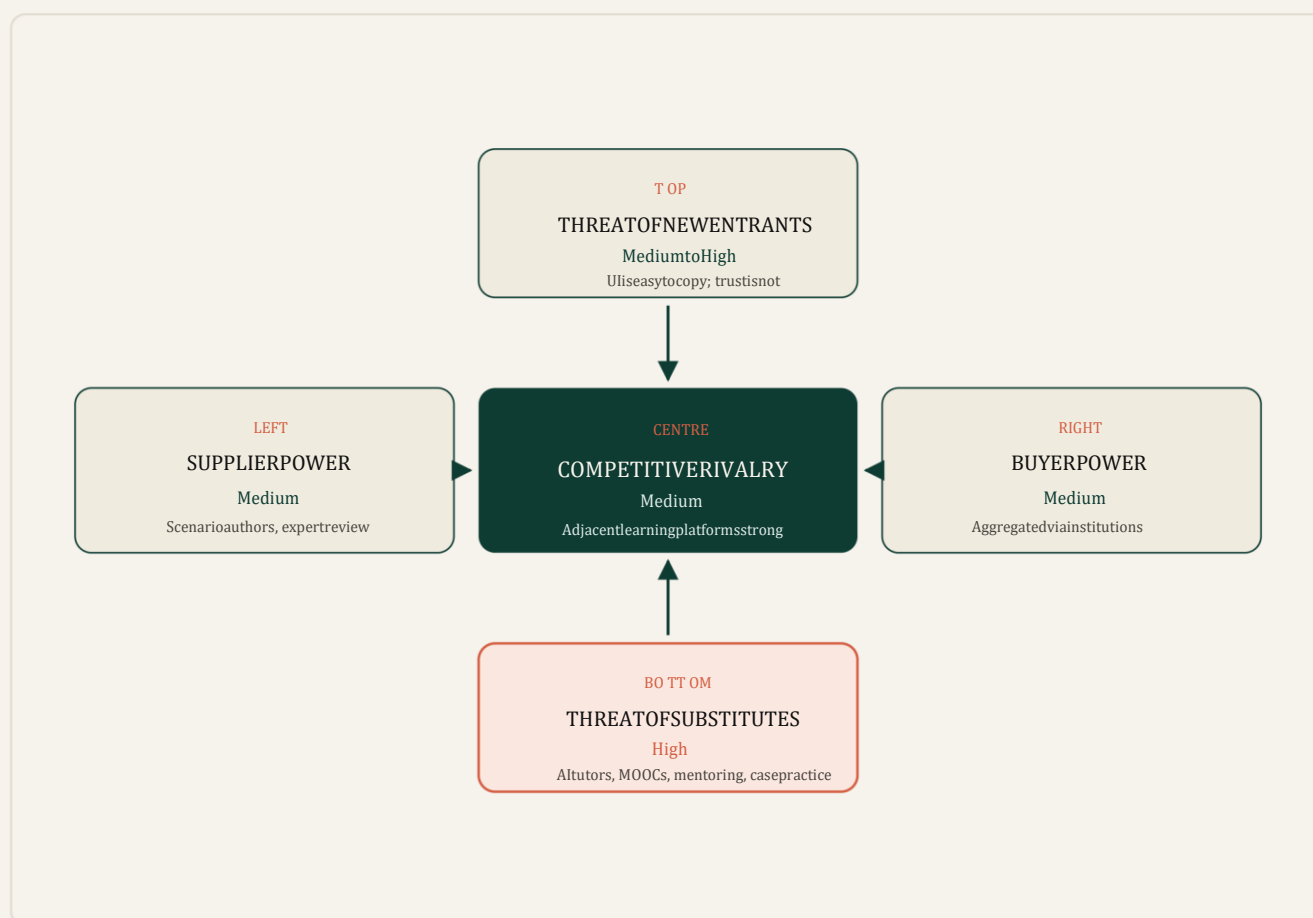


FIG. 12 Porter's Five Forces, with Acumen's interpretation of pressure on each force.

| FORCE                  | PRESSURE    | REPORT POINT                                                                                            |
|------------------------|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Competitive rivalry    | Medium      | Few direct competitors combine simulations, feedback, and peer matching; adjacent platforms are strong. |
| Threat of substitutes  | High        | Altutors, LinkedIn Learning, Coursera, mentoring, and case practices substitute easily.                 |
| Buyer power            | Medium      | Students are price sensitive; universities and societies aggregate demand.                              |
| Supplier power         | Medium      | Scenario quality and credibility depend on expert input.                                                |
| Threat of new entrants | Medium-High | UI is easy to copy; credible scoring, contextual scenarios, and network density are harder.             |

### Where Acumen actually competes

The strongest pressure is from substitutes — Altutors, Coursera, mentors, casebooks — all cheaper. Acumen wins, if at all, by offering what they do not: structured decisions under pressure, defensible feedback, and a peer whom a dethesame call differently. UI clones in weeks; calibrated feedback and active network density do not.

## From research to product decisions

The evidence map shows how each research finding translated into a product decision — Acumen is designed against a specific body of research, not a generic tech idea.

| RESEARCH FINDING                                                             | PRODUCT DECISION                                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Succession and governance are high-stakes in APAC family businesses [1][2]   | Uses succession and governance scenarios as flagship and premium content.         |
| Indonesian family companies are central to GDP and market capitalisation [7] | Anchor scenario stakes in realistic regional business contexts.                   |
| Political and family ties shape decisions in regional contexts [9]           | Build politically connected stakeholders into scenario decision trees.            |
| Young users need practical business learning, not more content               | Launch with short interactive simulations rather than long courses.               |
| Serious games can support soft-skill assessment [14]                         | Use interactive decision simulations as the unit of practice.                     |
| Game-based assessment is used in serious professional settings [4][5]        | Frame Acumen against an existing professional precedent rather than as a novelty. |
| Peer networks support learning and opportunity discovery                     | Add complementary peer matching directly to the loop.                             |
| Assessment validity takes time and data [8]                                  | Frame scoring as research-informed, not validated, at MVP stage.                  |

Each product decision is traceable to a finding, not intuition, and where the finding is weak the framing softens accordingly. Scoring is described as research-informed rather than validated because Imbellus and McKinsey took years and a large dataset to calibrate equivalent instruments [5][8]. The flagship scenario is anchored in the region most stressed by succession [1]; the broader library is not regionally locked, keeping the beachhead inclusive of users with no family-business context.



## A balanced verdict

Acumen is a feasible early-stage MVP with a coherent beachhead, a research-backed premium pathway, and a clear product loop. Its next challenge is not building more features, but validating whether user trust and return to the simulation, feedback, and peer loop.

### Where the MVP stands across four lenses

| LENS       | VERDICT             | REASONING                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------------|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Technical  | Feasible            | Scenario engine, weighted-tag feedback model, and profile-vector matching are implemented and stable; three scenarios live; conventional, cheap stack.                           |
| Strategic  | Coherent            | Reaching Next Gen successors via a student/society beachhead is internally consistent and matches the literature.                                                                |
| Commercial | Promising, unproven | Strong on the problem (83% agree on lack of practice) but soft on willingness to pay (34%); no paid pilot yet — the largest open question.                                       |
| Research   | Backed              | Leadership theory, succession evidence, and serious-games literature support the design. Scoring validation is not at Imbellus/McKinsey level [5][8]; we do not claim otherwise. |

### What we deliberately do not claim

Three caveats: three exploratory interviews are directional, not proof of demand; Acumen offers research-informed developmental feedback, not validated psychometric assessment; CV parsing, global maps, recruitertools, certificates, and fully validated scorings sit on the roadmap.

### The five hypotheses we now have to test

Listed in priority order; the first two carry the most product risk.

| #  | HYPOTHESIS                                                                        | HOW WE WILL TEST IT                                                                                   | PASS THRESHOLD                                                      |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| H1 | Users return for a second scenario within 14 days of their first.                 | Cohort tracking on a UCL pilot of 40+ users.                                                          | ≥ 35% return rate.                                                  |
| H2 | Users understand and trust the leadership signal without facilitator explanation. | Five-minute post-session interviews with 15 users; comprehension scoring against a four-point rubric. | ≥ 12 of 15 score 3 or above.                                        |
| H3 | A university society will run a cohort pilot of 40+ members.                      | Outreach to UCL Entrepreneurs Society, UCL Investment Society, and one external society.              | One signed pilot agreement by end of June 2026.                     |
| H4 | Users find peer matches valuable enough to message.                               | Telemetry on profile views and outbound messages within the pilot cohort.                             | ≥ 25% of completing users send at least one peer message.           |
| H5 | Next Gen successors find scenario realism credible.                               | Three exploratory interviews with Next Gen contacts via family-business advisors.                     | Qualitative agreement on three of four scenario realism dimensions. |

## SMARTnextstepsandlimitsofthisstudy

### SMARTrecommendationsforthenextsixmonths

Each action is specific, measurable, achievable, realistic, and timebound. Owners are placeholderstobe filled in by the team at kickoff.

| #  | ACTION                                                                                                                | MEASURE                                                                 | DEADLINE    | OWNER  |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|--------|
| R1 | Run a 40-user UCL cohort pilot of The Succession Crisis with telemetry on completion, return, and peer-message rates. | 40 completed sessions; H1 and H4 thresholds met.                        | 30 Jun 2026 | Maya   |
| R2 | Conduct 15 post-session comprehension interviews to test the feedback signallanguage.                                 | 12 of 15 score 3+ on the rubric.                                        | 15 Jul 2026 | Daniel |
| R3 | Author and ship two new scenarios (one operational, one ethical) to widen practice surface beyond succession.         | Both scenarios live, expert-reviewed by a UCL faculty member.           | 31 Jul 2026 | Moritz |
| R4 | Ship iOS and Android builds via React Native, sharing scenario engine and feedback model with the web bundle.         | Both apps in TestFlight and Play Internal Testing; smoke tests passing. | 15 Aug 2026 | Daniel |
| R5 | Calibrate the feedback model against five expert raters on a held-out scenario set.                                   | Inter-rater agreement $\kappa \geq 0.5$ on three of five dimensions.    | 31 Aug 2026 | Daniel |
| R6 | Sign one paying pilot with a society or course, even at a nominal price, to test willingness to pay.                  | One signed agreement; revenue collected.                                | 30 Sep 2026 | Maya   |
| R7 | Run three exploratory NextGen interviews via family-business advisors to begin testing the premium pathway.           | Three completed interviews with notes shared internally.                | 31 Oct 2026 | Moritz |

### Limitations of this study

Three limitations matter most. The primary research is small (18 survey responses, three in-depth interviews) — figures in Section 7 are directional, not representative. Access to NextGen successors is second-hand: we have read the PwC and McKinsey work but not interviewed Asian family-business successors directly. The feedback model is not yet calibrated against expert ratings; Imbellus and McKinsey needed years and a substantial dataset for high-stakes calibration [5][8]. These are why scoring is framed as developmental and the cohort pilot is the most important next step.

### The argument in one line

Research shows a leadership-readiness gap. A cumentestswheathershortsimulationscanhelp emerging leaders practise judgement, receive useful feedback, and form valuable peer connections. The MVP demonstrates the loop is buildable. The next six months — one cohort pilot, a calibrated feedback model, a paying pilot, and three NextGen interviews — will tell us whether users return, and whether they return for the right reasons.

# BusinessModelCanvas

The full Acumen Business Model Canvas, completed using the official Strategyzer template. The canvas describes the broad beachhead segment (students and early-career professionals) rather than the premium NextGentier, which is treated separately in the Value Proposition Canvas overleaf.

## The Business Model Canvas

Designed for:  
Young people looking to upskill and connect in business understanding

Designed by:

Date:

Version:

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Key Partnerships</b><br>UCL societies (Entrepreneurship Society, Investment society) for cohort pilots<br>UCL faculty for expert scenario review<br>APAC family business advisors<br>Cloud infrastructure providers (AWS)            | <b>Key Activities</b><br>Authoring and expert review of the scenarios (editorial work that makes the products USP and value)<br>Maintaining the typed scenario data model and scoring engines<br>Running cohort pilots and capturing telemetry (completion, return, etc..) | <b>Value Propositions</b><br>Practise judgement on realistic scenarios under simulated pressure, not abstract case studies.<br>A research informed leadership Signal in plain language.<br>Peer matching by complementary, meet people whose strengths fill yours<br>Short, repeatable sessions that fit in between lectures or commutes. | <b>Customer Relationships</b><br>Self serve digital product with cohort based onboarding (closed pilots, but not a spare public launch)<br>Society or course partnerships rather than 1:1 sales<br>Developmental tone, feedback is formative, not graded<br><b>Channels</b><br>Appstore (iOs and Google Play)<br>Facebook (Instagram) Ads<br>Flyers on campus<br>Promotional event days (gamified element)<br>UCL societies and course tie ins (primary at MVP)<br>Word of mouth from cohort pilots<br>Family business advisors as the route to the NextGen segment | <b>Customer Segments</b><br>Business and engineering students (UCL beachhead)<br>Young professionals, 0-4 years from graduation<br>Aspiring founders<br>Premium later: NextGen successors in APAC family businesses |
| <b>Cost Structure</b><br>Scenario authoring + expert review - £3000-6000<br>Hosting and serverless infrastructure - £1000<br>Marketing and acquisition (UCL/society events) - £3000<br>Tooling, design, trademark filing, legal - £1000 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>Revenue Streams</b><br>Individual scenario packs (£9 one off)<br>University cohort licenses (£1500 per cohort, when product is ready)<br>NextGen pilot programs (£8,000 per cohort - roadmapped)<br>Not subscription, not recruiter tools, and no certificates at MVP                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |



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FIG. 13 AcumenB

## Value Proposition Canvas • NextGen segment

The Value Proposition Canvas focuses on the premium later-stage segment, where willingness to pay is highest and the strategic stakes most acute: NextGen successors in Asia-Pacific family businesses preparing to take leadership without formal training pathways.

### The Value Proposition Canvas

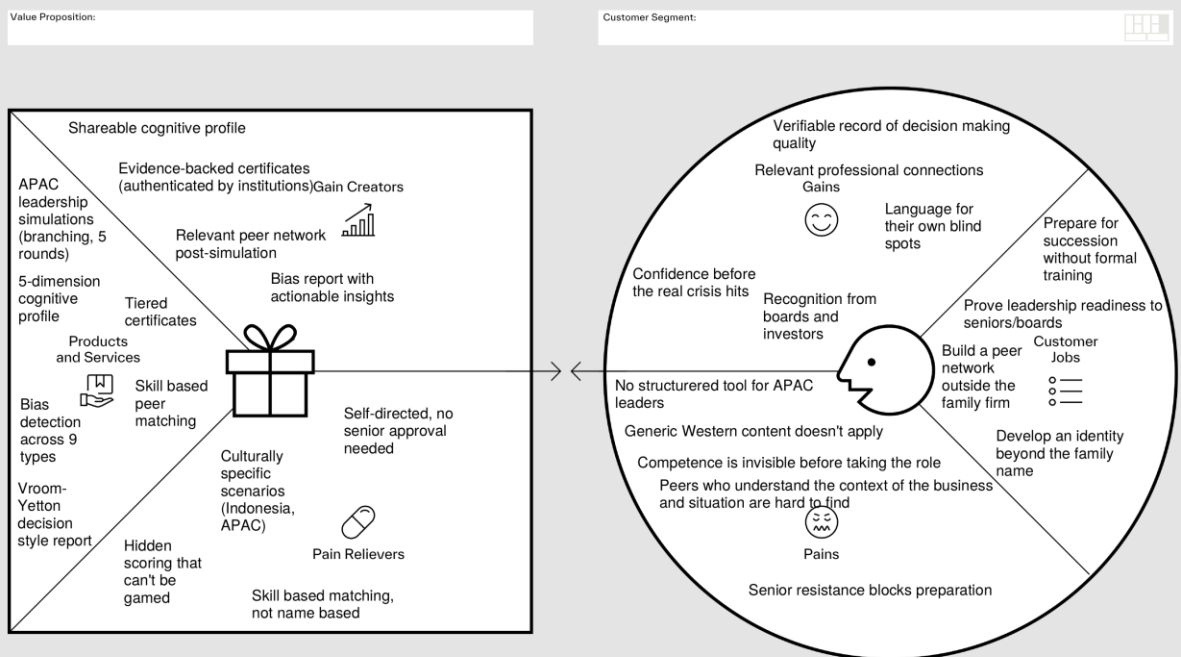


FIG. 14 AcumenV



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# Research instruments and architecture

## Interview guide · Pain points and gaps

- 1. What are the key skills you believe leadership and owning your own business require?
- 2. What do you find hardest about becoming a better leader or entrepreneur?
- 3. Do you feel like learning from others, especially people whose skills are different from yours, helps you grow? Or do you prefer to work independently?
- 4. How easy is it for you to meet people who actually challenge your thinking or complement your skills?
- 5. When you connect with people on platforms like LinkedIn, do those interactions actually lead to meaningful conversations?

## Interview guide · Concept reaction

- 1. If there was a platform where you could go through real business scenarios and get feedback on your decisions, how useful would that be?
- 2. Have you ever been in a situation where you had to make a difficult business or leadership decision? What did you do?
- 3. Do you find it hard to connect with people through cold emailing or rare LinkedIn and similar networks not very in-depth?
- 4. Do you like simulative contextual games, and would you want to see how others with similar or contrasting situational judgement responded?
- 5. Would you prefer something like this to feel more like a structured course, or more like an interactive experience?

## Interview guide · Profitability and value

- 1. If this platform could genuinely help you improve your decision-making and connect you with the right people, would you pay for it?
- 2. Which of these would matter more to you: certificates, skill improvement, networking opportunities, or career opportunities (if they were good)?
- 3. What would make you actually want to message or respond to someone on a platform like this?
- 4. If you could design the perfect platform to become a better leader, what would it look like?

## Source audit summary

| CLAIM                                                   | SOURCE           |
|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| USD 5.8 trillion APAC Next Gen wealth transfer          | [3]              |
| 43% Indonesian Next Gen citing senior resistance        | [1]              |
| PwC Global Next Gen Survey 2024 sample                  | [2]              |
| Indonesian family companies' role in GDP and market cap | [7]              |
| Serious games and soft-skill assessment                 | [14]             |
| McKinsey Game-Based Innovation Lab                      | [4]              |
| Imbellus / McKinsey simulation calibration              | [5][8]           |
| Political connections in Indonesia                      | [9]              |
| Upper-echelons / Vroom-Yetton / Hersey-Blanchard / Rest | [10][11][12][13] |

## Technical architecture

Acumen runs as a static client paired with a lightweight serverless backend for scenario state and profile storage. Scenarios are authored as decision graphs with weighted dimension tags; the feedback model aggregates these into a profile vector. Peer matching uses cosine similarity over profile vectors. No production user data beyond an anonymised profile vector is held at MVP stage.

## Group charter and meeting log

Required by the brief to evidence equitable contribution. The charters set expectations; the meeting log records progress, allocation, and any mitigations.

### Group charter · Group 47

| MEMBER           | PRIMARY REMIT                                         | SECONDARY CONTRIBUTION                                            |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Daniel Dutulescu | Product, scenario engine, feedback model design       | Technical architecture, bibliography, co-author of the report     |
| Maya Munasinghe  | Market research, survey design, validation interviews | Business model, value proposition canvas, co-author of the report |
| Moritz Bode      | Strategy, SWOT and Porter analysis, source audit      | Visual identity, MVP walkthrough, co-author of the report         |

### WORKING AGREEMENTS

1. Decisions are taken by simple consensus; if consensus cannot be reached after one meeting, the member with primary remit decides and the disagreement is logged.
2. Each member commits to an even share of writing and review.
3. Meetings happen weekly, with a fortnightly review of allocation against deliverables.
4. If a member is unable to deliver an allocated task, the group is informed at least 48 hours before the next meeting and the task is reallocated.
5. The module leader is informed promptly if any equity issues arise that the group cannot resolve internally, in line with the brief.

## Meeting log and AI use

### Meeting log

| DATE        | MODE      | PRESENT / ABSENT | DECISIONS AND ALLOCATION                                                                                                                                                    | MITIGATIONS                                                                  |
|-------------|-----------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 17 Mar 2026 | In person | All present      | Confirmed Acumen as the venture. Allocated initial research areas across leadership theory, family-business succession, and serious-games literature.                       | None.                                                                        |
| 24 Mar 2026 | In person | All present      | Reviewed initial source audit. Decided on the broader-beachhead, premium-NextGen positioning. Drafted product loop.                                                         | None.                                                                        |
| 31 Mar 2026 | Online    | All present      | Locked the four-step product loop. Daniel started scenario engine; Maya drafted survey; Moritz started SWOT and Porter analysis.                                            | Survey instrument shortened to seven items after pilot review.               |
| 07 Apr 2026 | In person | All present      | Reviewed first scenario draft (The Succession Crisis). Maya conducted the first exploratory interview. Confirmed visual identity direction.                                 | Scenario length reduced from 12 to 8 decision nodes after internal playtest. |
| 14 Apr 2026 | Online    | All present      | Second exploratory interview. Reframed the leadership signal as developmental rather than diagnostic following interview feedback. Moved peer matching forward in the loop. | None.                                                                        |
| 21 Apr 2026 | In person | All present      | Reviewed full draft. Agreed on hypothesis prioritisation and SMART recommendations. Allocated final report sections.                                                        | Word count contained by moving extended notes to the appendix.               |
| 28 Apr 2026 | In person | All present      | Final review of report layout, citations, and source audit. Submission preparation.                                                                                         | None.                                                                        |

### Use of AI tools

Generative AI was used in an assistive role consistent with UCL guidance: for drafting and editing prose, layout iteration, and proofreading. All research claims, citations, hypotheses, recommendations, primary research instruments, and the scenario library are the team's own work. The team reviewed every AI-assisted passage for accuracy and tone before inclusion.

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Practise judgement before it counts.

END OF REPORT · 1 MAY 2026